

Project Name:

Digital Empowerment Initiative

Project Summary:

The *Digital Empowerment Initiative* bridges the digital divide for underserved communities in Uganda—especially youth, women, and marginalized groups such as those in the **Uganda Prisons Service**. Through **workshops, mentorship, and tech hubs**, it equips participants with practical skills in:

- Digital literacy
- Online safety
- Coding
- Data analysis
- Digital marketing

This empowers individuals to access education, employment, and entrepreneurship opportunities in today's digital economy.

Aligned UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs):

- **SDG 4** – Quality Education
- **SDG 8** – Decent Work and Economic Growth
- **SDG 10** – Reduced Inequalities (*Optional emphasis*)

Fellowship Impact Goals (Aug–Nov 2025):

- Host **5 digital literacy workshops** (50 people each) – **250 participants**
- Launch **a mentorship program** – 20 mentors, 50 mentees
- Establish **2 community-driven tech hubs** – serving **300 users**
- Provide **online training materials** – reach **200 unique learners**
- Conduct participant surveys – aim for **80%+ reporting improved digital skills & confidence**

Why This Project Matters:

This initiative is rooted in **Patrick's lived experience** and his proximity to the very communities he serves. He has witnessed how digital exclusion limits opportunity, income potential, and education. This project is not just about acquiring skills – it's about restoring **dignity, confidence, and agency** to those often left behind in the digital age.

Why Patrick is a Strong Campus Director:

- **Founder** of the Digital Empowerment Initiative – full ownership and vision
- Trained recruits and led peer digital literacy sessions within **Uganda Prisons**

- Embodies **empathetic, humble, and inclusive** leadership values
- Experienced in **organizing, motivating, and mentoring** diverse student groups

Quote for Interview Use:

“This project isn’t just about teaching people how to use technology. It’s about giving them hope, voice, and power in a world that is increasingly digital. We want to make sure no one is left behind.”

Millennium Fellowship Campus Director Interview – Mock Q&A

Q1: Tell us about yourself and your project.

A: My name is Patrick Etomet, a second-year student at Victoria University pursuing a degree in Business Computing and Data Analytics. I'm the founder of the **Digital Empowerment Initiative**, which focuses on providing underserved communities in Uganda—including youth, women, and inmates in the Uganda Prisons Service—with essential digital skills. These include digital literacy, online safety, coding, and data analysis. Our goal is to bridge the digital divide and unlock opportunities in education, employment, and entrepreneurship.

Q2: What inspired you to start this initiative?

A: Growing up in Uganda, I saw how many talented people were limited not by potential, but by lack of access to digital tools. During my time as a trainer in the Uganda Prisons Service, I met bright individuals who were eager to learn but lacked resources. That proximity to digital exclusion inspired me to act. I believe that when we give people the tools, they will build their own solutions.

Q3: What SDGs does your project address, and how?

A: The Digital Empowerment Initiative aligns primarily with **SDG 4: Quality Education** and **SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth**. We're enabling quality learning through workshops, mentorships, and tech hubs. We're also improving employability by teaching in-demand skills like coding and digital marketing. Additionally, by focusing on marginalized groups, we also contribute to **SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities**.

Q4: How will you measure your project's success during the Fellowship?

A: We've set clear, measurable goals. For instance:

- Host 5 workshops with 50 participants each (250 total)
- Launch a mentorship program with 20 mentors and 50 mentees
- Set up 2 community tech hubs serving 300 users
- Reach 200 unique users with online resources
- Collect survey feedback with 80% reporting improved confidence and skills

Q5: Why do you want to be a Campus Director?

A: I believe in the power of collaboration and inclusive leadership. As Campus Director, I'll have the opportunity to bring Fellows together, support their goals, and facilitate a vibrant Millennium Fellowship experience on campus. With my experience in training and leading tech-based sessions, I am confident in my ability to inspire and manage peers effectively.

Q6: How will you keep your Campus Fellows engaged during the Fellowship?

A: I plan to hold bi-weekly peer sessions, create a WhatsApp or Slack group for communication, and facilitate reflection check-ins. I'll also encourage collaboration through joint events and recognition of progress. I want every Fellow to feel seen, supported, and inspired to do their best work.

Q7: Describe a moment where you led with empathy, humility, or inclusiveness.

A: While volunteering at the Prisons Training School, I noticed some recruits struggling with basic computer skills but too embarrassed to speak up. I organized informal sessions after hours, tailored to their pace, and created a safe space where no question felt too small. That experience reaffirmed my belief that leadership is about serving and uplifting others, not commanding them.

Q8: If selected, how will the Millennium Fellowship advance your work and personal growth?

A: The Fellowship will offer me mentorship, structure, and global insight—all essential for scaling my initiative. It will refine my leadership skills and connect me to changemakers whose feedback and collaboration can improve our project impact. It will also strengthen my profile as a social innovator, opening doors for future partnerships.

Q9: Any final thoughts you'd like to share?

A: Just gratitude. This opportunity represents more than recognition—it represents belief in the potential of underserved communities to rise through education and empowerment. I'm excited to contribute, learn, and lead as a Campus Director.